

RESTRICTED



ROYAL AUSTRALIAN AIR FORCE

580-1-1

13

TELEPHONE: PENRITH 2331

TELEGRAPHIC ADDRESS:
"AIRCOMMAND SYDNEY"

HEADQUARTERS OPERATIONAL COMMAND
RAAF
PENRITH 1W NSW

IN REPLY QUOTE 5/2/1/Air(6)

7 FEB 1966

Secretary
Department of Air
Russell Offices
CANBERRA ACT

DAFI.

UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECT - TULLY AREA

1. A report of investigations conducted by Headquarters RAAF Base TOWNSVILLE into the recent sighting of an unidentified flying object in the TULLY area is enclosed.
2. This headquarters believes that the depressions of the swamp grass were caused by small isolated waterspouts.
3. For information, Mr. R.C. RUSSELL who submitted the reports of the 13th and 21st January 1966, is a committee member of the Queensland Flying Saucer Research Bureau.

Encls 20

T.D. Wright
(T.D. WRIGHT)
Flight Lieutenant
for Air Officer Commanding

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REPORT ON AERIAL OBJECT OBSERVED



1. Name of Observer George Alfred PEDLEY, aged 28 years.....
2. Address of Observer Bruce Highway, Tully.....
3. Occupation of Observer Banana grower.....
4. Date and Time of Observation (Time given in 24 hour clock zonal time)
19/1/56 at about 0900 hours.....
5. Period of observation (s) About 15 seconds.....
6. Manner of observation: (Give details of own position by map reference if possible, or by known landmarks, and describe any equipment used in the observation).
Travelling on a tractor about 1/2 mile from farm house of Albert PENNISI, Rockingham Road, Durango. Attention attracted by hissing noise clearly heard over noise of tractor-similar to air escaping from tyre; checked tyres and was looking about for source of noise when he saw object about 25 yards ahead. No optical instruments used in sighting.
.....
7. Where was object first observed, e.g. overhead, coming from behind a hill, over the horizon etc.
Object about 25 yars ahead at height of about 30 feet rising vertically.....
8. What first attracted observer's attention, e.g. light or noise.
Loud hissing noise.....
9. Did object appear, as a light or as a definite object.
Definite object no light visible.....
10. If there was more than one object, how many were there, and what was their formation.
One object.....
11. What was the colour of the light or object Light grey; dull-non-reflecting.....
12. What was its apparent shape Two saucers-face to face.....
13. Was any detail of structure observable Object about 25 feet long and 8' to 9' deep. No structural detail observed......
14. Was any method of propulsion obvious No.....
15. Was there any sound Loud hissing noise which seemed to diminish as object rose.....
- * 16. Height, or angle of elevation First seen at treetop height 30! Rose vertically to about twice that height; then departed, climbing at about 45 degrees.....
- * 17. Speed, or angular velocity Extremely fast; No estimate of speed but much faster than an aeroplane......
18. State any experience which enables observer to be reasonably certain about the answers given to 16 and 17.
See 16. It was near treetops and these gave observer a good basis for estimating height......
- * Since it is normally impossible to estimate the height and speed of a strange object it will usually be better to endeavour to determine the angle of elevation of the subject, the angle through which it moved, and the time taken to do this.



Report on aerial object observed (Contd)

19. Direction of flight with reference to landmarks or points of the compass.

Rose vertically to about 60 feet and departed south west climbing at about 45 degrees; appeared to be rotating for full time observed.

20. Did the object remain on a straight path, deviate or manoeuvre at all.

Straight climbing path. (See 27.)

21. Was any trail of exhaust, vapour or light seen ... No.

22. Where did object disappear e.g. in mid-air, behind a hill, over the horizon.

Mid air; receded into distance.

23. Existence of any physical evidence such as fragments, photographs, or other supporting evidence.

Clearly defined near circular depression in swamp grass at point from which object seen rising; about 32" long and 25" wide. Grass flattened to surface of 4" of water lying in anti-clockwise curves

24. Weather conditions experienced at time(s) or observation(s).

Clear sky. Hot sunshine.

25. Location of any air traffic in the vicinity at the time of sighting.

Unknown but checked by R.A.A.F. Garbut.

26. Location of any meteorological stations in the general area Cardwell and Innisfail Post Offices are weather reporting Stations. Cairns Airport would be nearest Station.

27. Any additional information Observed reported this matter to Tully Police at 7.30pm on 19/1/66 and at 7am, 20/1/66 went with me to the site of the depression in the swamp. His version then included the information that the object (see 20) rose vertically appeared to dip slightly and then went off in straight climbing path. He then said (see 23) and further that there was no smell of combustion and no scorching of grass or trees visible; that the flattened grass or rushes was quite green when he first saw the depression; on his return that afternoon the grass had turned brown.

In this matter I formed the opinion that the depressed area in the swamp grass had been caused by a small helicopter and that the observer, in the early morning bright sunlight shining on the rotor may have mistaken the shape. His description of the takeoff lent some strength to my opinion. However there was cleared land to the east for about 200 yards where such an aircraft could have more safely landed instead of the position indicated by the observer, close to trees. Later I was informed by Wallace Evans of 68 Bryant Street, Tully, an electrician that he has seen similar markings in a swamp at Kurrumine Beach and is quite certain that it was caused by a whirlwind, sucking up water into a waterspout, uprooting the grass and laying it out in a similar pattern. At 3.30pm, 22/1/66 I took a sample of the grass at the site and have forwarded it under separate cover on even date.

A.V. MYLAN. Sgt. 1/c 3433.

Questions 25, 26 and 27 to be answered by interrogator. 26/1/66

MINUTE PAPER

(Write on this side only)

5/40/Air()

(21)

SUBJECT: UFO REPORTS - CAIRNS AND TULLY AREA

ABO

Reference

1. A UFO Reports received from CAIRNS and TULLY area on 17JAN66 and 20JAN66.

First report concerns UFO sighted in MACHANS BEACH area south of CAIRNS reported by Mr E.C. Russell of Box 151 Post Office BASINDA who was holidaying in the area at the time. This letter was acknowledged on 17JAN66 - copy of which is attached.

2. Second report was received from Sgt A.W. Moylan of TULLY Police by telephone on the morning of 20JAN66. This report concerned an UFO sighting approximately 12 miles South East of TULLY by Mr G. Tedley of TULLY. Preliminary investigation was made by Sgt Moylan before contacting this headquarters.

3. I advised Sgt Moylan that we would be forwarding proforma questionnaire for completion by Mr Tedley. This was also forwarded in the case of the first sighting to the Officer in Charge of Police Station BASINDA for completion by Mr E.C. Russell.

4. On Friday 21JAN66 I confirmed with Sgt Moylan that I was forwarding two copies of the proforma by mail that day and requested him to obtain a sample of the grass from the scorched area.

5. The sighting near TULLY was reported in the Townsville Daily Bulletin on Friday 21JAN66. Subsequent press reports were made on the sightings on 21 and 22JAN66, cuttings of which will be forwarded to HQOPCCM.

6. On Monday 24JAN66 I received a second letter from Mr E.C. Russell of BASINDA enclosing newspaper cuttings from the Local Newspaper. This will be acknowledged in due course.

7. In both cases it was confirmed that there were no Service or Civil aircraft operating in the areas at the time of the sighting. Photostat copies of all correspondence will be forwarded together with the completed proforma to HQOPCCM.

8. I will keep you informed of further developments.

NOA Walker
Flt Lt
E(I)SO

26
Innisfail District,
Tully Station.
26/1/66.

Relative to UNIDENTIFIED OBJECT SIGHTED NEAR TULLY, 0900Hrs.
19/1/66. Ref. 5/40/Air(18) of 21st. January, 1966.

Sir/,

I have to report receipt of your communication of the above reference on 25/1/66 and return herewith completed questionnaires forwarded by you under that cover.

On 21/1/66 at 3.30pm., in response to a request by P. L. Wallace I took a sample of the grass from the depression in the swamp grass at the site and I am forwarding that under separate cover, with a copy of this communication even date.

Please feel free to request any further information required.

Officer Commanding,
Headquarters,
RAAF Base,
Townsville.

[Handwritten signature]
A. V. MOYLAN. Sgt. 1/c 3463.

ACTION		When to be
☒	Index by Unit	
☒	Rept. Direct	
☒	Signed for OC	
☒	Submit reply for	
☒	Signature of OC	
☒	Reply to HQ 1/c	
☒	By	
☒	Special instructions	
☒	Seen by OC	

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